

Mango-glazed lemon pie

You might call this dessert a hybrid. It looks like a cheesecake but contains no eggs or cream. It does, however, include a small amount of sour cream, which complements the flavor and texture, making it **smoother** and lighter. The cream also smooths out the tofu. Unless you're a vegan, why not? You want soy in your diet and you may eat dairy. I'm a rule breaker—what can I say?

If you are a vegan, try soy sour cream, yogurt, or cream cheese. I purposely left those out because personally I don't care for the ingredients, and I won't make a substitute for substitute's sake when I feel quality is sacrificed. I do, however, recommend that everyone use organic sour cream, as it won't contain fillers, stabilizers, and other unwanted additives. Ener-G brand makes a good powdered egg replacer.

For this recipe, you will need a 9-inch [23-cm] springform pan, a larger pan (roasting or baking pan) for your water bath, and some aluminum foil. This pie really is not hard to make. Just prep and organize your ingredients, and you'll be done in no time.

CRUST

10 double graham crackers
2 tablespoons maple syrup
3 tablespoons canola or safflower oil

FILLING

$\frac{3}{4}$ cup coarsely chopped fresh mango (about 1 mango) [120g]
 $\frac{3}{4}$ cup light-colored unrefined cane sugar [150g]

1½ pounds extra-firm silken tofu (two 12.3-ounce packages) [750g total]

4 ounces sour cream, preferably organic [125g]

3 tablespoons egg replacer

$\frac{1}{4}$ cup plus 2 tablespoons fresh lemon juice

2 teaspoons vanilla extract

Pinch of salt

GLAZE

**2 cups coarsely chopped fresh mango
or whole blueberries** [300g mango or 250g
blueberries]

¼ cup plus 1 tablespoon water [75ml]

1 tablespoon arrowroot

1. **Preheat** the oven to 350°F [175°C]. Place a 9-inch [23-cm] springform pan on a large piece of aluminum foil. Fold up and wrap the foil around the entire outside of the pan. The purpose is to keep water from leaking from the water bath into the pie. Set the wrapped springform in a larger pan at least a couple of inches wider.
2. Prepare the crust by grinding the graham crackers to fine crumbs in a food processor. Add the maple syrup and oil. **Process** until the crumbs are evenly moistened. Turn into the springform pan. Using a small glass, start pressing down the crumbs. Take your time, slowly going round and round until the crumbs are evenly distributed on the bottom and partway up the sides.
3. To prepare the filling, rinse out the crumbs from the processor and puree the mango until very smooth. **Add** all the remaining filling ingredients and blend and blend and blend until the mixture is as creamy as possible, 2 to 3 minutes.
4. Pour the filling into the prepared springform pan and smooth the top with a rubber spatula. **Pour** enough hot water into the larger pan to reach about halfway up the sides of the springform. The water helps ensure a slower, more even cooking process.
5. **Bake** for 45 minutes. Turn off the heat and leave the pie in the warm oven for another 30 minutes without opening the door. Remove from the oven and let cool.
6. While the pie is cooling, make the glaze. In a nonreactive medium saucepan, combine the mango or blueberries, sugar, and ¼ cup [60ml] water. **Simmer** for 10 minutes, stirring frequently. Mix the arrowroot with 1 tablespoon water to form a paste and stir the paste into the glaze. Cook and stir for another minute or so until thickened. Remove from the heat and let cool.
7. **Spread** the cooled glaze over the pie. Cover and refrigerate for several hours or, ideally, overnight. When ready to serve, gently remove the rim of the springform pan. Use a sharp knife to cut the pie into slices.

SERVES 10 TO 12